

Decide whether and how to invest in AI for a business opportunity; then examine the seven connected dimensions.

STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

Compare options across dimensions, then record a direction and the evidence needed before implementation.

GO

Opportunity

Problem / people / intended value
Alternatives / priority / scope

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Employees photograph receipts, then retype merchant, date, amount and category. Finance checks policy and duplicate claims. Aim: less employee effort, quicker reimbursement and reliable controls.

1

Data

Sources & future value / Collect, acquire or label / Quality & coverage
Privacy & permitted use / Storage & access / Lifecycle & reuse

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Receipts and corrected claims exist, but links to final outcomes and reuse rights need review. Preserve corrections and exception reasons; keep bank details outside model inputs.

2

The AI team

Domain expertise / Technical skills / Communication & design
Obtain expertise / Retain & develop / Capacity & continuity

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Finance knows policy and exceptions. IT can integrate systems. Internal training would add labelling, evaluation and model operations; SaaS still needs internal assessment and oversight.

3

Organising AI development

Position the team / Decision authority / Portfolio & timing
Existing service or product / Build, partner or acquire / Agility & operations

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Finance owns the outcome; IT, privacy, payroll and employee representatives share decisions. Decide data and action authority before a later product review.

4

Technologies

Approach & simpler baseline / Model sourcing & adaptation / Performance & explainability
Human involvement / Hosting & infrastructure / Integration & lifecycle

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Compare better forms/rules, current-platform features, a hosted receipt service and an internal/adapted model. Start with extraction and human review; automated approval is separate.

5

KPIs & value

Strategic outcome / Customer & user value / Process & people
Financial value / Model performance / Evidence & review

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Baseline employee entry time, finance corrections, reimbursement delay, error and total cost. Savings depend on reduced rework and how released time is used.

6

Risk level & benefits

Performance uncertainty / Bias, ethics & safety / Security & resilience
Strategic dependence / Benefits & acceptable risk / SWOT & portfolio fit

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Potential value: convenience and faster payment. Risks: sensitive receipts, bank data, incorrect payments, bias in exception handling, provider dependence and security.

7

Culture & education

AI literacy / Roles & empowerment / Participation & ideas
Shared expertise / Continuous education / Adoption in practice

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

Employees want easier claims, but need trust and a correction route. Finance roles may shift from typing to exception review. Train reviewers and make ownership clear.

STRATEGIC OPTIONS: process improvement / buy / build / partner / defer

A Improve forms and rules. B Configure existing expense software. C Use an external receipt-processing service. D Build or adapt internally. E Defer AI while collecting better data.

STRATEGIC DIRECTION: choice / reason / conditions / owner / review date

Pursue an AI-assisted claims direction conditionally, beginning with receipt extraction and staff confirmation. Exclude bank data from model inputs and retain human payment approval. Finance sponsor to resolve data permissions, baselines, integration and route criteria before later vendor or product evaluation.

Sources, rights and useful information
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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

1.1 Sources & future value

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What exists internally or externally? What outcomes and corrections should we capture now for later uses?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-B.1

A Use existing claim and receipt records. B Capture corrections and final outcomes. C Add policy history.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

Finance already holds claims, receipts and final reimbursement records.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

Corrections and exception reasons are not consistently linked to receipts.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Inventory fields, provenance and permitted reuse; map links among receipt, claim and outcome.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Preserve outcome links regardless of whether AI is pursued; they improve later learning and auditing.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Data lead: map records and gaps with Finance in four weeks.

1.2 Collect, acquire or label

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Compare collection time, purchased data and expert annotation. What permissions, copyright terms and costs apply?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-B.1

A Label past receipts and exceptions. B Collect labels during normal review. C License external data.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

A can reuse past decisions. B records current corrections with context. C may add volume.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

A may lack labels or rights. B takes time to accumulate. C may not match policy and needs a licence.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Estimate label volume and expert time; check rights and retention before training.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Prefer capturing corrections in routine work; decide on a training set only after a feasibility estimate.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance and privacy: sample 100 records and estimate labelling effort. Review: week 4.

1.3 Quality & coverage

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Do volume, variety and freshness fit the task? Which populations, periods, labels or edge cases are missing?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-B.1

A Improve current forms. B Clean historical records. C collect better future records.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

Claims contain amounts, dates and categories already checked for payment.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

Image quality, currencies, languages, itemised receipts and missing fields may vary.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Measure coverage by claim type and employee group; document duplicate and exception rates.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Data quality work has value under every route; do it before claiming model readiness.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Data lead: profile a representative sample and missing fields. Review: week 4.

For LLMs: trace prompts, retrieval and provider retention/training. For trained models: separate training, validation and test data.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Data work is valuable for all routes: connect receipts, corrections and final outcomes. Training requires rights, labels and quality evidence.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Sources, rights and useful information
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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

1.4 Privacy & permitted use

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Can providers train on proprietary inputs or outputs? Check permitted recipients, training use, retention, access and exceptions.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

2021 + extension

A Keep sensitive data in-house. B Send limited receipt fields to a service. C allow broader provider processing only if justified.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

Claims data has identified owners and existing access controls.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

Receipts can show names, locations and card fragments; bank accounts live in related payment systems.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define permitted data, storage, retention, provider training use and deletion; see Risk 6.3.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Exclude bank details from model inputs; provider use of receipts needs explicit privacy and contract review.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Privacy lead: classify fields and set non-negotiable data boundaries. Review: week 4.

1.5 Storage & access

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Where should data live? Consider structure, proximity, transfer speed, security, capacity and administration.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-B.3

A Use existing governed stores. B Create a restricted data workspace. C use service storage.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

Existing finance systems provide access logs and retention processes.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

Cross-system access, image storage and provider logs are not mapped.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Diagram flows for each route, including prompts, images, outputs, logs and backups.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Hosting depends on data boundaries and route; no blanket approval for copying claims.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT: map access and storage requirements with privacy. Review: week 4.

1.6 Lifecycle & reuse

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

How will sources, versions, corrections and outcomes stay linked? Set retention, deletion and recovery arrangements.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Added prompt

A Keep only claims. B retain corrections and outcomes. C discard records after required retention.

+ DATA ASSETS / FUTURE VALUE

Reimbursement outcomes are already recorded.

- DATA GAPS / RESTRICTIONS

Valuable error labels and reasons may be lost or retained without a lawful purpose.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Agree provenance, retention, employee notice, reuse rights and data minimisation.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Capture corrections and outcomes where permitted; review future value and privacy together.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance and privacy: propose a governed lifecycle. Review: week 4.

For LLMs: trace prompts, retrieval and provider retention/training. For trained models: separate training, validation and test data.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Set permitted data and provider boundaries before considering SaaS or training. Preserve useful corrections only with an agreed purpose and lifecycle.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Capabilities, sourcing and continuity

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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

2.1 Domain expertise

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Who understands the task and recognises a plausible but wrong result? Include people affected by the workflow.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-C

A Use Finance as domain owner. B add a cross-functional claims group. C delegate definition to a supplier.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

Finance knows policy, exceptions and what a correct claim means.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

Reviewers have limited time; a supplier cannot set company policy.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Name experts to define fields, unacceptable errors and exceptions.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Retain task definition and acceptance criteria inside the company under every route.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance sponsor: reserve reviewer time for strategy and later evaluation. Review: week 4.

2.2 Technical skills

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Which statistics, data engineering, modelling and software skills does this project actually need?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-C

A Configure a service. B build a small integration team. C train or adapt a model in-house.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

IT understands identity, finance systems and payment interfaces.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

Internal modelling, data engineering and evaluation capacity are unassessed.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Map skills and ongoing effort by route, including security and model monitoring.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Treat internal training as a capability investment, not a free alternative to SaaS.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT lead: produce a route-by-route capability map. Review: week 4.

2.3 Communication & design

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Who translates between specialists and decision makers? Who designs understandable outputs and interfaces?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-C

A Show extracted fields for correction. B show confidence and source region. C automate silent entry.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

Employees and Finance can explain confusing claim steps.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

Silent errors could be hard to detect or contest.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define an understandable review screen and a simple correction path.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Prefer visible extraction and employee confirmation before any automated decision.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

UX lead: collect staff and reviewer requirements. Review: week 4.

For fine-tuning: name data-curation and model-evaluation skills. For agents: include integration and permission-testing expertise.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Finance must define the task; IT, design and data skills depend on the chosen route.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Capabilities, sourcing and continuity

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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

2.4 Obtain expertise

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Compare upskilling, hiring, partnerships and acquiring a team. Which capabilities must remain internally?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-C

A Retrain existing staff. B hire specialists. C partner or acquire capability. D buy a service.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

Finance and IT supply context that outside teams would need.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

Costs, time to competence and external dependence are unknown.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Compare skills, time and control across the routes.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep governance and evaluation skills in-house even if the model is purchased.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: cost capability options and identify likely owners. Review: week 4.

2.5 Retain & develop

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

How will people learn, share knowledge and stay? Is time for education and technical investigation funded?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-C

A Document evaluation methods. B pair specialists with Finance. C rely on a single supplier.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

A shared claims process can teach transferable lessons.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

Staff turnover or vendor lock-in could erase operational knowledge.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Specify documentation, handover and export requirements.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Invest in retained knowledge about the workflow and data; model code alone is insufficient.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT and Finance: outline a knowledge-transfer plan. Review: week 4.

2.6 Capacity & continuity

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Who has time to review, maintain and support the system? Name backups and unresolved skill bottlenecks.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Added prompt

A Run a dedicated service team. B add to existing IT support. C rely on provider operations.

+ EXISTING EXPERTISE

IT already handles finance-system incidents.

- SKILL / CAPACITY GAPS

No AI monitoring, retraining or escalation budget has been assigned.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Estimate support load, incident response and policy-change maintenance.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Cost the full lifecycle before committing to a build or subscription.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: assign provisional operations owner and budget range. Review: week 4.

For fine-tuning: name data-curation and model-evaluation skills. For agents: include integration and permission-testing expertise.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Even a purchased model needs internal evaluation and governance. Long-term support is part of the investment.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Structure, delivery and portfolio
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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

3.1 Position the team

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

Centralised, distributed or hub-and-spoke? Which arrangement enables shared expertise and access across departments?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Finance-led with IT support. B central AI team. C distributed ownership with shared standards.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

Finance has a clear outcome owner; IT has integration experience.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

Privacy and payroll need seats at decisions, not late consultation.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define sponsor, data owner, technical owner and escalation path.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Use Finance ownership with shared technical and governance support.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: draft roles and review with stakeholders. Review: week 4.

3.2 Decision authority

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Who owns budget, outcomes and access? Which people must be involved to avoid delays and unclear responsibility?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Finance approves scope. B privacy approves data use. C IT approves access. D payroll controls payment authority.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

Existing departments have relevant mandates.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

No single decision map covers AI training, provider access and payment actions.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Record who can approve data processing, spending, deployment and exceptions.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep payment approval separate from model output and document decision rights.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: agree decision gates before feasibility work. Review: week 4.

3.3 Portfolio & timing

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Balance near-term improvements and longer-term exploration. Which projects share capabilities or compete for resources?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Prioritise claims. B prioritise other AI opportunities. C fund common data foundations first.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

Claims affect most staff and produce visible administrative friction.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

Opportunity cost against other work has not been quantified.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Compare expected value, reach, effort and shared foundations.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Advance claims to feasibility only if it ranks well against the wider portfolio.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Strategy group: rank candidate opportunities. Review: week 4.

Keep application delivery separate from model sourcing and hosting. A system built internally can still depend on an external model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Finance-led ownership needs explicit privacy, IT and payroll decision rights.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Structure, delivery and portfolio
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List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

3.4 Existing service or product

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Could software or AI as a service meet the need? Consider configuration, provider dependence and price changes.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Configure present expense platform. B add a connected service. C replace current workflow later.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

Existing software already stores claims and approval history.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

Its extraction capability, export rights and configuration limits are unknown.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Describe required functions and data boundaries for a later market review.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Consider current-platform capability as an option, without assuming it is sufficient.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT: document existing features and integration constraints. Review: week 4.

3.5 Build, partner or acquire

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Compare internal development, outsourcing and acquiring technology. Consider retained knowledge and maintenance.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Build internally. B buy SaaS. C partner. D acquire a team or capability.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

A offers control and adaptation. B can be faster. C shares specialist skills. D may add immediate capacity.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

A needs staff and support. B adds provider dependence. C needs coordination. D adds price and integration risk.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Score routes against privacy, accuracy, adaptability, capability and cost.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep route selection open until requirements and evidence are clearer.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: prepare a strategic route comparison. Review: week 4.

3.6 Agility & operations

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What evidence should be gathered before committing to a delivery route? Separate strategic direction from later prototypes, procurement and operation.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-D

A Improve the process now. B run a later feasibility stage. C commit to deployment.

+ ORGANISATIONAL ENABLERS

Staging lets the company gain evidence before a large commitment.

- FRICTION / DEPENDENCIES

Investment gates and evidence thresholds are undefined.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Set criteria for moving from strategy to trials, vendor review and implementation.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Process improvements can proceed; AI deployment requires later evidence.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: define the next decision gate. Review: week 4.

Keep application delivery separate from model sourcing and hosting. A system built internally can still depend on an external model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Rank claims against other opportunities; use evidence gates before later procurement or trials.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Models, people and deployment

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4.1 Approach & simpler baseline

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Could rules, optimisation or ordinary software solve the task? Compare predictive, generative and hybrid approaches.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-E

A Simplify forms and rules. B use receipt extraction. C use generative AI for exceptions.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

Many fields are structured and may need only ordinary software.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

Varied receipts and unclear descriptions may still need AI assistance.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Benchmark a non-AI baseline against time, error and maintenance.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Evaluate the simplest route that meets the intended outcome.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT and Finance: list tasks suitable for rules versus AI. Review: week 4.

4.2 Model sourcing & adaptation

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Use an existing model, adapter, fine-tuning or custom training? What task evidence, data, licences and skills justify it?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Added prompt

A Use current-platform or prebuilt model. B adapt a model. C train internally.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

A can reduce data needs and startup time. B may fit company claims better. C gives more direct control.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

A may limit adaptation. B needs labels and skills. C requires data, infrastructure and ongoing operations.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Specify data and evaluation needs for each route; see Data 1.2 and Team 2.2.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Do not infer that custom training is needed; retain it if generic tools cannot meet requirements.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Technical lead: estimate route requirements, without choosing a vendor. Review: week 4.

4.3 Performance & explainability

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What performance and explanations must any approach provide? Which errors or uncertainties would make AI unsuitable?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-E

A Use extraction with confirmation. B use automatic categorisation. C automate decisions.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

Fields can be compared with the receipt and corrected by staff.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

Accuracy may differ by language, image quality or expense type.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define acceptable errors, explanations and testing by subgroup and claim type.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Start with explainable assistance; higher authority needs a separate risk decision.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance: define critical error classes and acceptance criteria. Review: week 4.

For LLMs: compare retrieval and adaptation. For agents: list permitted tools/actions and approvals enforced outside the model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Start with a simpler baseline, then compare prebuilt, adapted and internal technology on whole-workflow value.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Dorien Herremans | aiSTROM (2021) | Basis: III-E | Card labels are practical groupings; additions marked.

dorienherremans.com/aiSTROM

Models, people and deployment

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4.4 Human involvement

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

Who labels or corrects examples? Which tasks are augmented or automated, and which judgements remain with people?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-E

A Employee checks fields. B Finance reviews exceptions. C automatic approval for narrow cases.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

Existing human approval can catch unusual claims.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

Review burden could erase time saved; automatic errors affect reimbursements.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Quantify review volume and identify decisions that must remain human.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep human approval for payment and disputes at this strategy stage.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance: map decisions and potential review effort. Review: week 4.

4.5 Hosting & infrastructure

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Compare cloud, managed service, on-premises and edge. Include training/inference needs, capital and operating costs.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-E

A Process in current environment. B use managed cloud. C use external SaaS.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

Current identity and finance systems can support controlled access.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

Image transfer, residency, costs and logs vary by route.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Map security, availability, access and cost requirements before architecture choice.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Choose hosting after data boundaries and operating needs are defined.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT: document infrastructure constraints and data flows. Review: week 4.

4.6 Integration & lifecycle

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

How do inputs and outputs connect to work? Define versioning, updates, monitoring, fallback and action boundaries.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Added prompt

A Export extracted fields only. B connect claims workflow. C allow agentic payment actions.

+ FIT / CAPABILITY

Existing claims workflow has approval checkpoints.

- COST / LIMITATIONS

Integrations can propagate mistakes; action access expands security consequences.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define interfaces, audit trail, rollback and permissions; see Risk 6.3.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Assist data entry first; agentic submission or payment is a later distinct decision.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT: map integration boundaries and permissions. Review: week 4.

For LLMs: compare retrieval and adaptation. For agents: list permitted tools/actions and approvals enforced outside the model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Receipt extraction with human confirmation is the initial direction. Agentic approval or payment is a separate later choice.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Outcomes, measurement and continuation
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

5.1 Strategic outcome

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What business outcome would make AI worth considering? Identify the current baseline and a meaningful future measure.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Reduce employee effort. B speed reimbursement. C reduce Finance rework.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

The pain is familiar and broad across the workforce.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

These outcomes could compete if review demands increase.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Rank outcomes and set a baseline for each.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Treat employee convenience and reliable payment as joint goals.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: agree primary and guardrail measures. Review: week 4.

5.2 Customer & user value

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Could value mean better service, easier decisions or a new offering? Who benefits and how will you observe it?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Employee self-checks fields. B Finance does all review. C maintain current entry.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

Most employees dislike repeated manual entry and correction.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

Staff may distrust extraction or fear claim surveillance.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Ask employees about time, errors, transparency and correction experience.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Design for less friction with an easy dispute path.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

HR and Finance: gather representative user feedback. Review: week 4.

5.3 Process & people

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Measure time, quality, rework and workload across the whole workflow. Where will released capacity be used?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Remove typing. B shift work to exception review. C change policy and forms first.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

Less routine entry could free Finance capacity.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

Exception handling may become more complex; savings are not automatic.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Measure time across employee, manager and Finance roles.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Count net workflow effects, including new review work.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Process owner: baseline end-to-end effort. Review: week 4.

For generators: use task rubrics and review effort. For agents: measure completed work and action errors, not just answer quality.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Measure employee time, Finance rework and reimbursement quality together.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Outcomes, measurement and continuation
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

5.4 Financial value

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Consider revenue, margin, investment and ongoing costs. Separate staff capacity from realised cash savings.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Buy a subscription. B build/adapt internally. C improve process without AI.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

The high claim volume could make small time savings material.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

Licences, integration, labels, support and oversight add costs.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Model total ownership cost and benefits over a realistic horizon.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Do not claim cash savings from released time without a credible redeployment plan.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Finance: build scenarios and sensitivity ranges. Review: week 4.

5.5 Model performance

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Which task measures and consequential errors would later determine whether an approach is adequate?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Measure field extraction. B measure correct complete claims. C measure reimbursement outcomes.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

Existing correction and payment records can support evaluation.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

A high extraction score may hide costly errors or extra review.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Specify datasets, subgroup checks and end-to-end guardrails.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Judge technology by workflow value and critical errors, not model accuracy alone.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Data and Finance: define evaluation protocol. Review: week 4.

5.6 Evidence & review

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What evidence would justify investing, changing direction or stopping? Who owns the later measurement?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-F

A Review quarterly. B review after policy changes. C wait for complaints.

+ POTENTIAL VALUE / EVIDENCE

Claims processes already have audit and reporting cycles.

- COST / MEASUREMENT GAPS

Drift and new receipt formats may go unnoticed between reviews.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Decide owners, thresholds, feedback capture and stop criteria.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Make ongoing review part of the investment case.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: set evidence and review cadence. Review: week 4.

For generators: use task rubrics and review effort. For agents: measure completed work and action errors, not just answer quality.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

A credible case includes full cost and net workflow effects, then periodic evidence review.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Uncertainty, trade-offs and SWOT
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

6.1 Performance uncertainty

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What if useful accuracy cannot be reached or conditions change? Which uncertainty is decisive before investment?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-G.1

A Employee confirmation. B Finance exception review. C automatic entry with later audit.

+ SAFEGUARDS / REVERSIBILITY

Confirmation and sampling make extraction errors reversible.

- EXPOSURE / CONSEQUENCES

Wrong amount or category could delay or misdirect reimbursement.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Identify severe errors and the cost of correction; link to KPI 5.5.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep reversible assistance as default until error consequences are measured.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Risk owner: define acceptable error and escalation thresholds. Review: week 4.

6.2 Bias, ethics & safety

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Who could be disadvantaged or harmed? Consider historical bias, missed errors and responsibility for consequences.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

2021 + extension

A Test by group and claim type. B require human review for exceptions. C automate broadly.

+ SAFEGUARDS / REVERSIBILITY

Policy review and appeals can reduce unfair outcomes.

- EXPOSURE / CONSEQUENCES

Training on past decisions may reproduce unequal treatment or mistaken policy.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Check outcomes across employee groups and expense categories; provide appeal route.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Do not automate adverse decisions without evidence and accountability.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

HR and Finance: define fairness review and appeal process. Review: week 4.

6.3 Security & resilience

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

What deceptive inputs, data access or compromised components could cause harm? How will you detect and contain it?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

2021 + extension

A Isolate bank details. B minimise receipt sharing. C grant agent access to payment systems.

+ SAFEGUARDS / REVERSIBILITY

A isolates payment data. B limits receipt disclosure. Existing approval controls can contain mistakes.

- EXPOSURE / CONSEQUENCES

A still needs integration control. B leaves some exposure. C greatly expands the reach of a compromised agent.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Threat model data flow, provider use, prompt injection, privileges and incident recovery.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Exclude bank data from model input and prohibit autonomous payment authority at this stage.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Security and privacy: set data and permission boundaries. Review: week 4.

For agents: test prompt injection, tool misuse and reach into other systems. For predictive models: test drift and adversarial inputs.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Use reversible assistance and human payment approval. Risk choices depend on potential harm, not model accuracy alone.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Uncertainty, trade-offs and SWOT

STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

6.4 Strategic dependence

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

How exposed are we to unfamiliar technology, skill gaps, vendors, price changes or organisational dependencies?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-G.1

A Keep exportable data. B depend on one provider. C develop internal capability.

+ SAFEGUARDS / REVERSIBILITY

Portability and internal evaluation skills preserve choices.

- EXPOSURE / CONSEQUENCES

SaaS terms, price or availability may change; internal skills may be scarce.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define exit, data export, continuity and long-term support requirements.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Compare dependence across routes, not just purchase price.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

IT and sponsor: define exit criteria. Review: week 4.

6.5 Benefits & acceptable risk

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Compare expected value with the size and reversibility of possible losses. Who can accept the remaining exposure?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-G.2-3

A Accept limited assisted-entry errors. B require near-zero errors. C defer AI.

+ BENEFIT AT STAKE

Faster claims and fewer repetitive tasks could justify controlled, reversible mistakes.

- POSSIBLE LOSS / LIMIT

Incorrect or late reimbursement harms staff; savings may not offset new reviews.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Compare quantified value with severity, reversibility and stakeholder tolerance.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Conditional investment only where benefits exceed remaining risk.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: agree risk appetite with staff and Finance. Review: week 4.

6.6 SWOT & portfolio fit

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Bring the findings together: internal strengths and weaknesses; external opportunities and threats. What changes the choice?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-G.3

A Continue claims feasibility. B improve process first. C prioritise another opportunity.

+ STRENGTH / OPPORTUNITY

Broad employee reach and existing claims data are strengths; better records enable future work.

- WEAKNESS / THREAT

Privacy, integration and uncertain benefit are threats; fragmented labels are a weakness.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Consolidate SWOT with portfolio evidence from Organisation 3.3.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Keep claims in portfolio with conditions, rather than treating it as an approved product.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Strategy group: review portfolio fit after baselines. Review: week 4.

For agents: test prompt injection, tool misuse and reach into other systems. For predictive models: test drift and adversarial inputs.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Privacy, security, error and strategic dependence have distinct responses; compare residual exposure with the value at stake.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

Dorien Herremans | aiSTROM (2021) | Basis: III-G | Card labels are practical groupings; additions marked.

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Participation, literacy and lasting use
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

7.1 AI literacy

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What should leaders, users and wider staff understand about AI capabilities, limitations and appropriate uses?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-H

A Train all staff on assisted entry. B train only Finance. C rely on tool hints.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

Employees already know the claim workflow and can spot obvious receipt errors.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

AI limitations and data handling may be misunderstood.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define practical literacy for claimants, reviewers and managers.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Give all affected staff concise guidance; deepen Finance training.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

HR: outline role-based learning. Review: week 4.

7.2 Roles & empowerment

DECISION STATE

Direction agreed

How will work and authority change? Discuss concerns, preserve useful expertise and identify where AI supports people.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-H; III-E

A Let employees confirm fields. B let Finance correct all fields. C fully automate entry.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

Staff can correct errors at the source.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

A new burden on employees or hidden monitoring would reduce trust.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Clarify authority, correction and appeal rights for each role.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Make staff confirmation easy and keep Finance responsible for policy decisions.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Process owner: draft future role map. Review: week 4.

7.3 Participation & ideas

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

How can staff help identify opportunities, shape the workflow and challenge unhelpful designs?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-H

A Co-design with staff. B consult Finance only. C impose a finished workflow.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

Employees and reviewers know common pain points and exceptions.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

A narrow design group can miss accessibility and unusual claim types.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Gather examples across departments, languages and expense patterns.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Involve varied users before committing to a route.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

HR and Finance: recruit representative participants. Review: week 4.

Tailor practice to the system: interpreting forecasts, checking generated content, or supervising and stopping delegated actions.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Employees and Finance need clear roles, correction rights and practical AI literacy.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: validate the first three card assumptions with the named owners before choosing a route.

Participation, literacy and lasting use
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

FICTIONAL | 1,200-person company | Should we use AI to improve employee expense claims? | Finance, staff, IT, privacy | Sep 2026 | No supplier selected

List options A/B/C; refer to them in the + and - fields. Record requirements, a reasoned direction and the next evidence.

7.4 Shared expertise

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Would a centre of excellence or lighter community help? Decide how knowledge, examples and specialists are shared.

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-H

A Share claim lessons across teams. B keep expertise in one project. C outsource learning.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

A cross-functional group can reuse data and governance practices elsewhere.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

Scattered decisions make repeated mistakes more likely.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Create shared records of definitions, evaluations and decisions.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Treat this opportunity as a source of reusable capability.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

AI lead: set a lightweight knowledge repository. Review: week 4.

7.5 Continuous education

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

Plan ongoing learning for developers, managers and users. Who updates guidance as systems and tasks change?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Paper III-H

A One-off launch training. B continuing refreshers. C informal peer help only.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

Finance already trains staff on policy changes.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

Models, policies and threats can change after launch.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Plan refreshers for reviewers and users; tie to incident and policy review.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Budget continuing education under any AI route.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

HR: include learning in lifecycle cost. Review: week 4.

7.6 Adoption in practice

DECISION STATE

Gathering evidence

What would appropriate use look like if adopted? How would the organisation notice burden, errors or avoidance?

OPTIONS / POSSIBLE RESPONSES (A, B, C...)

Added prompt

A Gradual supported adoption. B mandatory switch. C optional parallel process.

+ PARTICIPATION / SKILLS

The current process offers a baseline and fallback.

- ADOPTION BARRIERS

Parallel work can add cost; a forced switch can damage trust.

WHAT IS NEEDED / EVIDENCE / LINKED SHEETS

Define adoption measures, support and rollback conditions.

DIRECTION / REASON (OR WHY UNDECIDED)

Prefer staged adoption after strategy and feasibility gates.

NEXT EVIDENCE OR ACTION / OWNER / DATE

Sponsor: set change and feedback criteria. Review: week 4.

Tailor practice to the system: interpreting forecasts, checking generated content, or supervising and stopping delegated actions.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: linked trade-off / strategic implication

Co-design and staged adoption reduce friction; maintain skills as policy and technology change.

PRIORITY UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Next: owner to document unresolved requirements and bring them to the overview decision.

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